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Zoho Creator Setup and Platform Exploration

Aim

To set up a Zoho Creator account, explore its platform interface, and understand the various modules and features it provides for building low-code applications.

Software / Tools Required

- A computer/laptop with internet connection
- Web browser (Google Chrome / Microsoft Edge)
- Valid email ID for account registration
- Zoho Creator account (creator.zoho.com)

Theory

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code application development platform that allows users to design, develop, and deploy custom business applications without extensive programming knowledge. It provides an intuitive drag-and-drop interface for building forms, a built-in database to store records, a workflow automation engine, and Deluge (Data Enriched Language for the Universal Grammar Engine) — a proprietary scripting language — for adding custom business logic.

Setting up and exploring the Zoho Creator environment is the first step before building any application. The platform dashboard gives access to key modules such as Form Builder, Workflow Builder, Deluge Script Editor, Reports, and Pages, each of which serves a specific purpose in the application development lifecycle.

Platform Modules Explored

Module / Section	Purpose	Observation
Form Builder	Drag-and-drop creation of input forms and fields	Fields like text, number, date, dropdown, lookup, subform available
Deluge Script Editor	Add custom logic, validations and automation using Deluge scripting language	Used for workflows, button actions and custom functions
Workflow Builder	Automate business processes using triggers (on create/edit/schedule)	Supports form triggers, schedules and custom functions
Reports	Generate list view, summary view, and pivot reports from form data	Built-in chart and report types available
Pages	Design custom dashboards / home pages for the application	Drag-and-drop widgets like reports, forms, images, HTML
Deploy / Publish	Make the application live and accessible to users	Options to publish to organization or public users

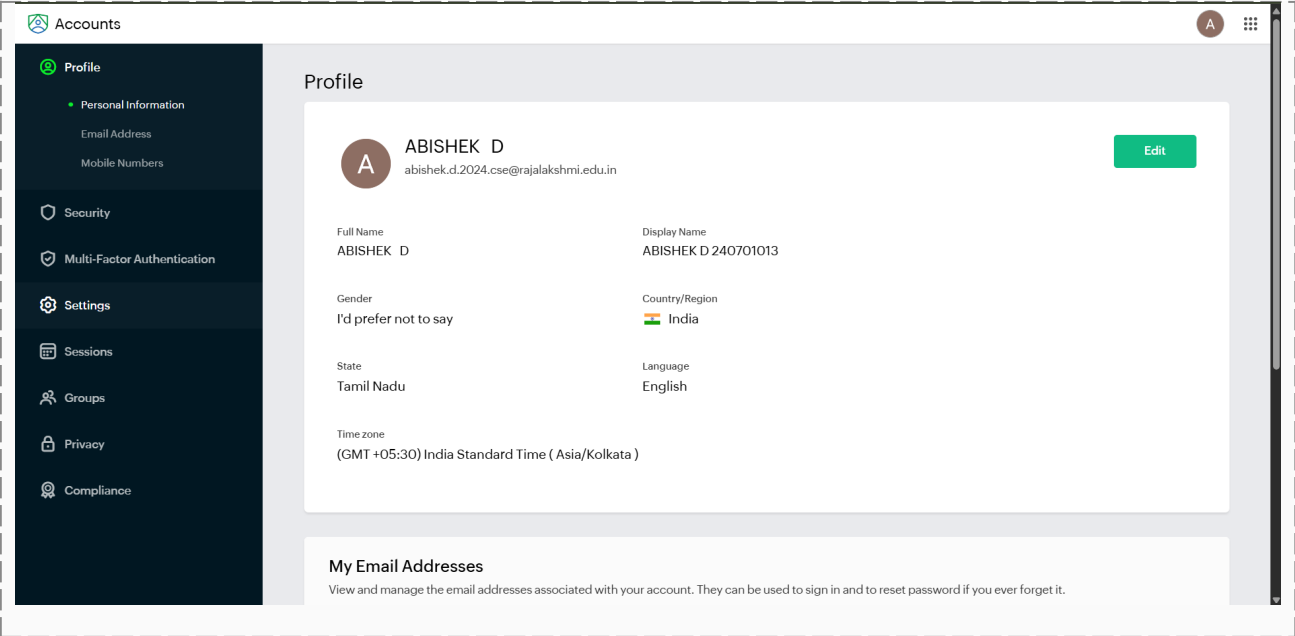
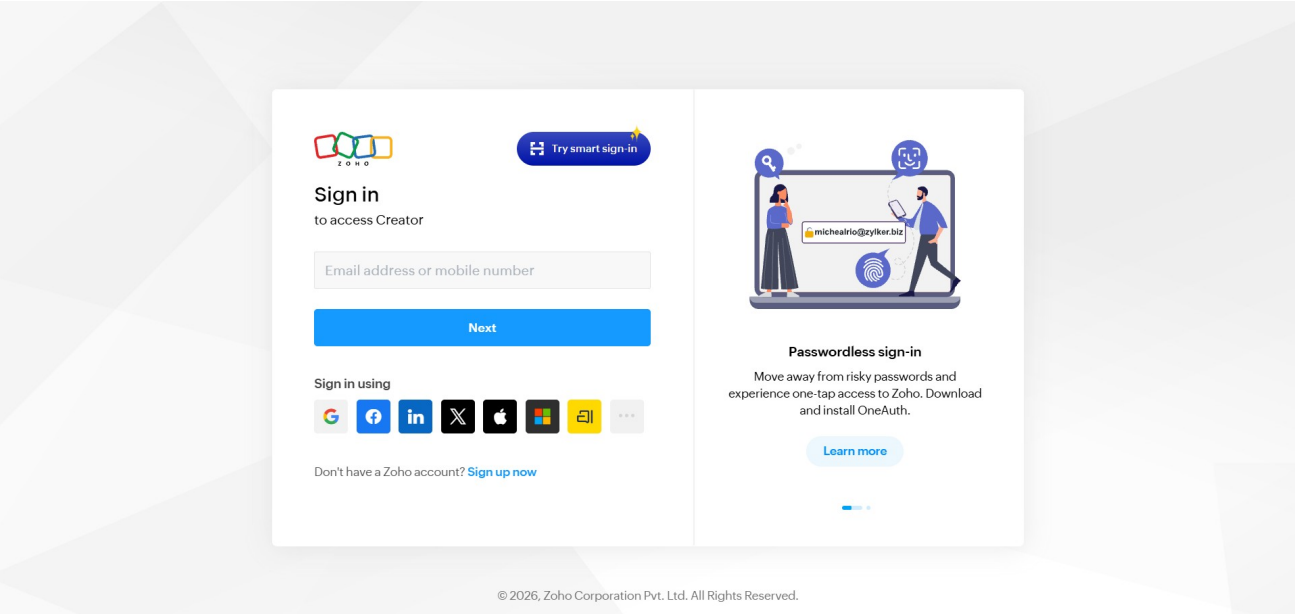
Procedure

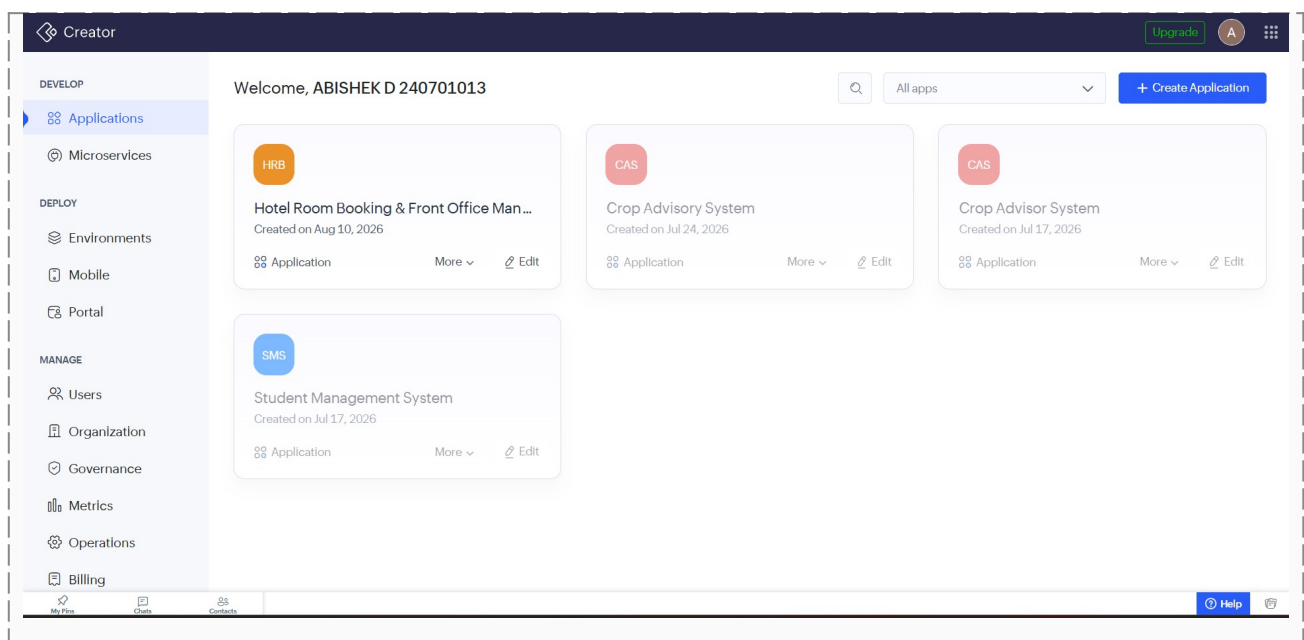
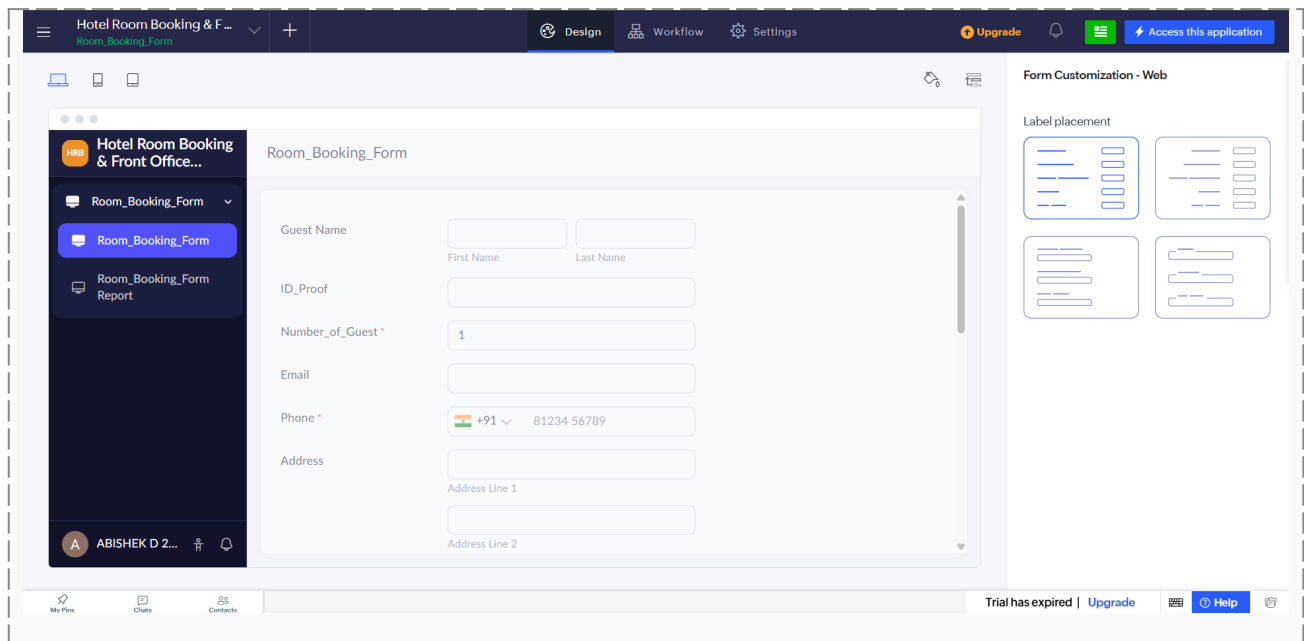
1. Open a web browser and navigate to the Zoho Creator website (creator.zoho.com).
2. Click on 'Sign Up for Free' and register a new account using an email ID, or sign in with an existing Google/Zoho account.
3. Verify the email address and complete the account setup process.
4. Log in to the Zoho Creator dashboard and observe the home screen layout.
5. Explore the 'Create New Application' option and view the available application templates.

6. Create a blank sample application and open it to view the development workspace.
7. Explore the left-side navigation panel — Forms, Reports, Pages, Workflows, and Deluge Scripts.
8. Open the Form Builder and observe the available field types (text, number, date, dropdown, lookup, subform, etc.).
9. Open the Deluge Script editor and explore its code-writing interface and built-in function suggestions.
10. Check the 'Deploy' / 'Publish' option to understand how an application is made live for users.
11. Note down observations for each module explored in the platform.

Screenshots

Add screenshots for each of the steps below to support the observations recorded above.





Result

The Zoho Creator account was successfully set up, and the platform's core modules — Form Builder, Workflow Builder, Deluge Script Editor, Reports, and Pages — were explored. A clear understanding of the platform's interface and application development workflow was obtained, which will be used as the foundation for building applications in the subsequent experiments.

